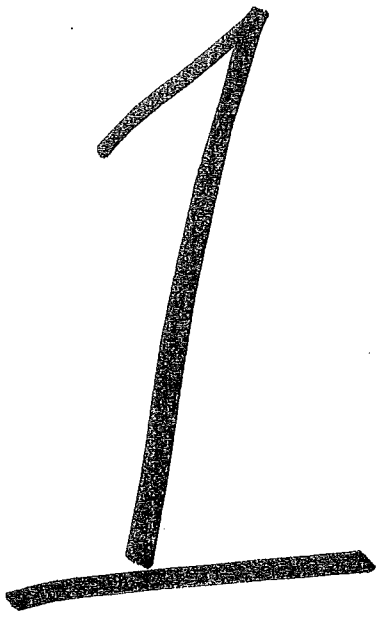


Journal of Sociolinguistics 9/1, 2005: 74–94

Self-presentation in sociolinguistic interviews: Identities and language variation in Panambi, Brazil

Ana M. S. Zilles
Universidade Federal do Rio Grande do Sul, Brazil

Kendall King
Georgetown University Washington, D.C.

This paper contributes to recent work examining the role of identity, and in particular the uses of language for self-presentation and the expression of individual identity, through the analysis of two sociolinguistic interviews from a community of German origin in southern Brazil. Drawing from a quantitative study of variation in the southern state of Rio Grande do Sul, we conducted a detailed analysis of the interviews of two women of different ages and social backgrounds. We first describe the social, cultural and historical context of the interviews, and then discuss how our two speakers use their linguistic resources to express varied, and at times conflicting, aspects of their identities. More specifically, we show how our participants seem to maintain certain in-group, German-linked features, yet also use out-group or Brazilian features in order to index both the (local) German and (regional) Brazilian aspects of their identities. Our data and analysis highlight how participants' identity and language use patterns can be better understood through close analysis of the content of their discourse.

KEYWORDS: Identity, Portuguese, German, interview, Brazil

The last decade has witnessed a dramatic increase in sociolinguistic research examining identity, and in particular, the uses of language for self-presentation and the expression of individual identity (e.g. Bell 1999; Bucholtz 1999; Rampton 1995; Rampton 1999; Schilling-Estes 2004). Work from several different theoretical and methodological lines, including, for instance, ethnographic studies of small groups in particular contexts (Eckert 2000), analysis of individuals' life histories (Johnstone 1996), and examinations of self-presentation through narrative (Schiffrin 1996) has pointed to the fluid, multi-faceted, and locally constructed nature of identity. Much of this research represents a shift either away from – or towards more critical use of – social categories such as gender or age, which have traditionally been the hallmark of variation analysis. These new strands of research, in contrast, give greater

© Published by Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005
9600 Garsington Road, Oxford OX4 2DQ, UK and 350 Main Street, Malden MA 02148, USA.

attention to individual speakers' strategic use of dialect features for the expression of identity; within these approaches, use of particular forms are thus less likely to be treated as 'behavior' which patterns in regular ways across groups, and more likely to be viewed as individual 'performance' of a particular social practice (Coupland 2001). Well-discussed examples of such strategic uses of language include Rampton's (1995) analysis of 'crossing' among adolescents in England, and subsequent research analyzing 'styling the other' (1999), or how individuals use specific language features to index social group affiliations 'in situations where the acceptability and legitimacy of their doing so is open to question' (1999: 422).

The present paper seeks to contribute to this large and growing body of work through the analysis of data from two sociolinguistic interviews from a German immigrant community in southern Brazil. Drawing from a much larger study of variation in the region, we analyzed in close detail the language used by two women of different ages and social backgrounds. Grounding these interviews in the immediate and historical local context, here we provide further evidence of how language use is both constrained and creative, as our speakers draw from their particular linguistic resources to express the varied, and in some respects conflicting, aspects of their identity. Specifically, we show how, even in brief sociolinguistic interviews, participants' identities can be uncovered through close analysis of the content of their discourse. Their discourse provides clues concerning their language ideologies, their idealized identities which they wish to project, as well as how these ideologies and identities relate to both the local historical and social context and their language use patterns.

In our analysis of the linguistic features and discourse content within the interviews, we draw on the recent body of work which examines 'crossing' although stress that our participants are not 'putting on a voice' or being artificial in any way (Rampton 1995) as both women, through geography, inheritance, and ideology, have legitimate claims to German and Brazilian identities. Yet like the three Texan women profiled by Johnstone, who strategically and variably use southern ways of speaking (1999), the two women in our study demonstrate both 'in-group' and 'out-group' linguistic characteristics and illustrate the often blurry and shifting lines between these two categories. Further, for our participants, their movement back and forth across these lines also serves to reconcile the tension between the different identities which have arisen in part due to the stigmatization of 'German-ness' during the fascist-socialist *Estado Novo* period of Brazilian history discussed below.

CONTEXT

The context of the study is Panambi, a town of 30,000 in Brazil's southernmost state, Rio Grande do Sul. Panambi is well known as a German area, both linguistically and culturally. German immigration to Brazil, which

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

commenced in 1824, was supported by the imperial government and political élites to meet three objectives: (1) to occupy the southern territories, which were long-time objects of dispute between Spain and Portugal; (2) to 'whiten' the population through inter-ethnic marriage; and (3) to 'improve' the local cultural mix through the infusion of an immigrant population perceived to be educated and hard-working (Seyferth n.d.; Seyferth 1991). German immigrants, for their part, came to the Americas largely to escape widespread poverty related to the dearth of suitable farmland (Cunha 1996). The German *colônias* ('colonies'), as they were known, became prosperous communities and were generally characterized by segregation from the local population. In part because of this early tendency towards economic and cultural autarchy, the colonies have retained (aspects of) their German character.

However, as Auer, Arnhold and Bueno-Aniola (in press) note, it is impossible to speak of one German speech community within the state of Rio Grande do Sul. The same could be said of Panambi. One complicating factor is the variation in membership claims (Auer et al. in press) and manner of self-identification, both apparent in the range of terms characterizing ethnic identity in use in the region. For instance, individuals explicitly identify themselves or others as *Alemão* ('German'), *colono* ('peasant', 'settler', 'tenant farmer'), *gaúcho* (a person from Rio Grande do Sul, in idealized form, a macho cowboy), or *Brasileiro* ('Brazilian'), roughly stretching along a continuum of greater to lesser affiliation with German ancestry.

Panambi was founded in 1899 as a private enterprise by Herman Meyer (Baernert-Fuerst 1989; Knies and Costa 1996). *Colonos* came from previously established German colonies in the state, and spoke at least two distinct dialects ('Pomerainian' and 'Hunsrückisch'); these newcomers joined Brazilians and Portuguese who were already in the area. Roughly 20 years later, an additional group of immigrants arrived who were speakers of Swabian German, substantially increasing the 'German-ness' of Panambi. During these first decades, German likely held a prominent position in both private and public domains as German *colonos* tended to intermarry, thus maintaining German-speaking households, and also to organize their own infrastructure, including (often Protestant) churches and German-language schools (Auer et al. in press). Many remained in contact with their German families, some of whom regularly sent German-language media. Perhaps as a consequence, relative to other German communities in Brazil, there seems to have been a greater emphasis on learning and speaking standard German (Peter Auer, personal communication, April 18, 2002).

The growing discomfort within the country that Germans were failing to integrate and assimilate with the local population – a concern dating back to the 1880s – translated into oppressive governmental policies under the fascist-socialist *Estado Novo* (1937–1945) of Getúlio Vargas. Under Vargas and the guise of the Second World War, German was severely repressed across the country: German-language schools were closed, as all languages other than

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

Portuguese were banned. Although German was still used in certain domains, during this period, German monolinguals were persecuted, publicly humiliated, and in some instances, jailed.

While these events likely played a role in the shift towards Portuguese in Panambi over the twentieth century, other factors, such as a general shift in the region away from small-scale farming to light industry, in-migration to the region by Brazilians from other states, and out-migration by younger German-Portuguese bilinguals to work in cities or to farm less-inhabited (often indigenous) lands, were also likely important in the loss of German (Auer et al. in press). Indeed, recent accounts of language use patterns in Panambi suggest that German is now largely restricted to private domains, with Portuguese serving as the primary public language, and with greater German usage found among older and more rural populations (Baernert-Fuerst 1989).

Thus, *colonos* of different generations in Panambi grew up within distinct cultural and linguistic environments; their language skills reflect those circumstances. For instance, most elders are German-dominant, attended German-language schools as children, and have strong first- or second-hand recollections of repression under Vargas. Middle-aged adults, in turn, often grew up in German-dominant homes, but were exposed to substantial amounts of Portuguese from a young age, as it was the obligatory language in schools by then. Both groups differ sharply from the current youth of Panambi, who tend to be Portuguese dominant if not Portuguese monolingual, and have grown up in bilingual contexts where German functions are restricted to informal home and community domains.

METHODS

Data for the present analysis were drawn from the VARSUL database, a corpus of about 300 sociolinguistic interviews from 12 communities in the southern states of Brazil (Zilles 1994). Of the 26 interviews conducted in Panambi in the early 1990s, those of two women were selected for analysis here. Both interviews covered a similar range of topics, including cultural practices of the community, changes in the region, typical customs (e.g. recipes, dances), and childhood memories. Participants also introduced a number of topics that were of particular interest to them, such as travel, local commerce, and family matters.

The first, Alice (PAN05), was chosen because previous analysis had suggested that her interview contained large amounts of metalinguistic talk (Trevisan and Zilles 2001). The second, Lina (PAN23), was chosen at random. For both women, the interview was the first and only encounter with the VARSUL team. Interviews were transcribed following VARSUL's protocol. We conducted detailed analysis of the interviews along several parallel lines. At the discourse level, we analyzed the ways in which interviewees discussed and

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

described their own experiences and viewpoints. We initially identified and examined participants' 'metalanguage', and then widened the scope of our analysis to include the multiple ways in which the women used language to position themselves relative to their local region, German ancestry, and social standing. Analysis was grounded in the notion that individual identity is 'shifting and multiple, something people are continually constructing and reconstructing in their encounters with each other and the world' (Cameron 2001: 170). Our focus was thus on how Lina and Alice chose to reveal and to perform aspects of their identity throughout the conversations.

Simultaneously, we analyzed the linguistic features and specific variable rules of interviewees' speech. We selected features for analysis in two ways: first, we drew from previous work in the region which indicated the social stratification of certain linguistic variables (e.g. Prade 1996; Vandresen 1999), and second, we reviewed the audiotapes and transcripts for features which – to native speakers of the regional standard – were marked as typical of German-Portuguese bilinguals. In addition, we also quantitatively and qualitatively examined certain lexical and syntactic characteristics of interviewees' speech that stood out as (highly) unusual or marked. In our quantitative analysis of variable rules, three features were analyzed using VARSUL's *Interpretador* (©Engesis), a software program which facilitates automated searches of the transcripts by relating, across different lines: the orthographic record of the speech; the phonetic notation of specific features; and the word class. Quantitative analyses consisted of chi-square tests of significance based on percentages.[1]

RESULTS

After briefly describing our two participants' backgrounds, we summarize Alice and Lina's use of three independent variable rules. We then discuss how Alice and Lina position themselves as individuals within the interviews, qualitatively analyzing the content of their discourse and usage of these and other forms. Our two study participants, Alice and Lina, are alike in many ways. In addition to their shared status as long-time Panambi residents, they both identify as German in origin and cite German as their first language. Both women were married for much of their lives and both are mothers. In addition, Alice and Lina spent their formative years in the rural areas – the *interior* – well beyond Panambi. However, there are some substantial differences between the women as well: Alice, 71 at the time of the interview, is 30 years older than Lina and attained four more years of formal schooling than Lina (nine versus five). And as described below, over the course of each interview, the two women presented divergent pictures of life in their region and positioned themselves differently in relation to local norms and regional culture, through both the content of their speech and their use of particular forms in their speech.

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

Quantitative findings

The speech of the two women is characterized by many local phonological features that stand in great contrast to the speech found in the state capital of Porto Alegre. Examples of these local or *colono* features include: unstressed final vowels /e/ and /o/ which are less raised to /i/ and /u/; dental stops /t/ and /d/ which are rarely palatalized; and lastly, the highly salient and stigmatized lack of distinction between strong and weak /r/ (a phonemic distinction in Portuguese). There are also prosodic, morphosyntactic, and lexical differences which are clearly perceived as local or *colono*. When appropriate, and as space permits, we discuss them in our qualitative analysis. We focus our quantitative discussion on three features which are widely perceived in southern Brazil as associated with German-ness[2]: (1) replacement of stressed, word-final /ãw/ with /on/; (2) retention of alveolar /l/ in word-final position; and (3) devoicing of consonants.

One easily identifiable area of German phonological interference into Portuguese is the non-nasalization of vowels[3] (Prade 1996). The replacement of the standard nasal diphthong /ãw/ with /on/ (e.g. /ale'mon/ instead of /ale'mãw/, 'German')[4] is a very salient variable in this respect. This feature is highly stigmatized: it is reproduced in jokes about German communities, and in reported speech it is imitated with derogatory force. In analyzing this variable, we restricted our quantitative analysis to /ãw/ in stressed, word-final position. This is a very frequent context in Portuguese because many common words end in /ãw/ due to the historical convergence of different Latin nasal syllable forms. This diphthong is also an augmentative suffix (e.g. *amigo* > *amigão* 'friend'), and part of the suffix which derivates nouns from verbs (*adorar* > *adoração* 'to adore' > 'adoration'). For our purposes, this context seemed particularly interesting as stressed syllables are potentially more salient in perception and acquisition. Furthermore, changes are less expected in stressed syllables, which tend to be preserved, at least by native speakers.[5] Our analysis found that although both speakers vary between the standard pronunciation /ãw/ and its realization as /on/, the difference between them is significant (see Table 1): Alice used a greater number of the highly marked, non-standard forms, for both common (e.g. *não* 'not') and uncommon (e.g. *cremação* 'cremation') words.

A second trait associated with German ancestry is the retention of alveolar /l/ in syllable- or word-final position. According to Tasca (2000: 335), studying VARSUL's corpus, in Panambi, the alveolar /l/ is found in 77 percent of the data, a higher percentage than that found in an Italian community (71%) or in a community on the border with Argentina (24%). These communities differ from the capital, Porto Alegre, where /l/ vocalization is preferred and contrasts with its velarization. In our analysis, we counted only tokens of /l/ in word-final position, excluding German words. As evident in Table 1, we found that Lina and Alice do not differ at all in this respect as they are both almost categorical in the use of the variant in this position.

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

Table 1: German-associated variants in the speech of two women from Panambi

	N/total	%	Significance test
Replacement of /ãw/>/on/			
Alice	74/241	31.0	
Lina	19/403	5.0	
Total	93/644		χ^2: 80.36, $p < .01$
Alveolar /l/ in word-final position			
Alice	45/46	98.0	
Lina	101/102	99.0	
Total	146/148		No difference
Devoicing: /b/>/p/, /d/>/t/, /v/>/f/			
Alice	16/1327	1.2	
Lina	6/1606	0.3	
Total	22/2933		No difference

The third trait associated with German-ness is devoicing. According to Prade (1996), in the German dialects of Rio Grande do Sul, /b/, /d/, and /g/ are pronounced as /p/, /t/, and /k/. For instance, *dunkel* ('dark') is realized as *tunkel*. In transferring this feature to Portuguese, bilinguals are seen as pronouncing *vertate* for *verdade* ('truth'); *queprá* for *quebrar* ('to break'), and *ninkem* for *ninguém* ('no one'). Prade adds that this process also happens with fricatives, for example /v/ is pronounced as /f/ (e.g. *feneno* for *veneno* 'poison'). In our quantitative analysis we counted only the alternations between bp, dt, and vf, as these could be accessed by automated search. We found that devoicing was quite rare in our data, despite the fact that this feature is believed to be very common among German-Portuguese bilinguals and is popularly stereotyped. This stereotype is evident in the (derogatory) reference to a Brazilian of German ancestry as an *alemão patata* ('potato-y German') instead of using (the standard) pronunciation, *batata*. This insult has a double edge: first, it pokes fun at the image of Germans as potato eaters; second, it mimics ethnic Germans' stereotyped tendency to not distinguish between voiced and unvoiced consonants. As evident in Table 1, Alice does more devoicing than Lina, but the numbers are low and the difference is not statistically significant.

In short, quantitative analysis of our participants' usage of three forms perceived as expressing 'German-ness' revealed three different trends. In examining the replacement of stressed, word-final /ãw/ with /on/, we found that Alice was much more likely to use this markedly German feature than Lina. In turn, in our analysis of the retention of alveolar /l/ in word-final position, we found that both women were roughly equally likely to make

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

extensive use of this highly *gaúcho* or German form. Lastly, our review of devoicing of consonants – perhaps the most widely stereotyped German speech form – suggested that, for both Lina and Alice, devoicing was exceedingly rare. In order to shed light on these different trends, we now turn to our qualitative examination of how these and other variables are used differently by Lina and Alice within the interview in ways that reflect their particular histories and experiences, but also illustrate how the women actively construct their current identity through language. Our analysis also highlights how they use language to index their varied identities, either by using linguistic features associated with German ancestry or by avoiding them.

Qualitative findings

Alice and Lina frame themselves in sharply different ways in the course of the interview. This is perhaps most evident in how they position themselves relative to their German heritage and immediate community. From the outset of her interview (see Extract 1), Alice presents a romantic portrait of German life in Rio Grande do Sul:[6]

Extract 1

A: ...E a nossa vida de casa era muito bonita, né? [as]- era assim em casa [os re-]- as reuniões, né? [entre]- [de]- de noitezinha a família toda unida, né? [e]- e a mãe, ela dava uma hora bíblica pra nós, né? lia, todos os dias nós tinha quinze minutos de silêncio com meus pais, né? isso era muito bonito, e [o] cânticos, músicas folclóricas alemães, a gente então praticava, né? e [s-] sobre, como se- [a]- [pausa] a vida social, vô dizê que afinal nesse tempo havia, então quando nós tava maior, com dezasseis anos [eu pude]- foi o primeiro passo, que eu [fu-]- pude í ao baile, acompanhando do meus pais, né? Non tinha assim que a gente podia í sozinha, né? nós era [muito]- muito cuidadas, né? e a gente obedecia, e quanto penso hoje eu fui muito lindo isso, né? (lines 14–31)

And our life at home was really beautiful, you know? It was like this at home [repair for gender] gatherings, you know? [between] [in] in the evening the family altogether, you know? And my mother, she had bible hour for us, you know? She read [for us]; every day we had fifteen minutes of silence with my parents, you know? This was very lovely, and [the] hymns, German folkloric music, we then practiced, you know? And about, how do you- [pause] social life, I will tell you that during this time, when we were older, like sixteen years old, [I could] it was the first step 'cause I could go to a dance, accompanied by my parents, you know? It wasn't like we could go alone, you know? We were [very] very cared for, you know? And we obeyed, and when I think about it today, it was very lovely all of this.

Alice depicts a close-knit family which values respect, communication, good behavior and tradition as well as bible study and literacy. This idealized presentation of a gentile and cultured family life contrasts sharply with some

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

Brazilian popular images and jokes, which tend to portray German immigrants as ill-mannered, unsophisticated, and unkempt (Auer et al. in press). Within this idealized world, Alice also signals her relatively privileged economic position. Her father owned a cattle ranch (the idealized *gaúcho* occupation *par excellence*). Other indications of her higher status are found in her discussion of the family library, her wedding and dowry preparations, and her family members' professional positions. Related to this privileged position, Alice identifies with German *colono* life, not only through her description of family and community practices, but through her stated perceptions, values, and desires. Correspondingly, she repeatedly claims that Rio Grande do Sul is the most beautiful place in Brazil, for instance, comparing her home area very positively with São Luís, a city in the far north of the country. Concomitant with these extremely positive evaluations of her local region are Alice's many references to Germany and German culture. For instance, she mentions relatives in Germany, the experiences of her family members who live there, and her desire to travel to Germany. She also expresses values which are (stereo)typically German, such as respecting parents, teachers, and other authorities, cleanliness, being *caprichoso* ('careful, detail-oriented, tidy'), and the beauty of nature.

Correspondingly, Alice's lexicon and syntax also contain features that mark her as a non-native speaker of Portuguese. As a lexical example, when Alice explains that as a child she was involved in a bet about who could ride her horse fastest, she (mis)uses the word *proposta* ('proposal') instead of *aposta* ('bet'): *Eu fiz **proposta*** ('I made a ***proposal***', line 280). As for morphosyntactic choices, for instance, she uses a reflexive pronoun with a verb that is not reflexive (*Casei com vinte e <s-> oito, vinte e sete me noivei* 'I got married when I was twenty-eight, (at) twenty-seven (I) engaged **myself**', lines 351–352), probably through analogy with *casar-se* ('to marry'), a verb which is (variably) reflexive. Furthermore, in Extract 2, Alice uses a non-standard *como* ('like') instead of *que* ('than') to form the comparative:

Extract 2

A: Era alemão, (inint.), né? mas falava perfeitamente, até melhor brasileiro **como** eu. (lines 177–178)

He was German, (unintell.), right? He spoke perfectly, even better Brazilian **like** me.

Alice's incomplete mastery of Portuguese is also evident in her non-standard attribution of gender, in Extract 3:

Extract 3

I: E que castigo! E na escola tinha -
A: Aí tinha, como se diz essas -
I: Palmatória?

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

A: Palmatório.
I: A senhora ('pegou') o tempo?
A: É, era do palmatório, mas graças a Deus eu não tomei. (lines 297–303)

I: And what punishment! In the school there was -
A: There was, how do you say these -
I: Hand-slapping?
A: Hand-slapping.
I: Did they (hit) you ever?
A: Yes, it was hand-slapping, but thank God I never had it.

Alice mis-attributes the masculine form *o palmatório* twice, despite the fact that the interviewer provides her with the correct feminine form initially (*a palmatória*). Similar markers of Alice's status as a non-native speaker of Portuguese are evident periodically throughout the conversation, for instance, in her frequent (mis)use of prepositions. For instance, in describing a recipe (*um pouco sal e farinha* 'a little flour', lines 54–55), she omits the required preposition *de* ('of'). In discussing her relationship with her parents (*nós num tinha segredo contra eles assim, né?* 'we didn't keep secrets from them', lines 89–90), she uses *contra* ('against') instead of the standard *com* ('with').

While many of these features seem related to her restricted access to Portuguese, others, such as non-standard use of /on/ and devoicing (described in quantitative section above), seem linked to her identity construction. For instance, Alice employs non-standard /on/ at different rates as she moves through more or less culturally German topics within her interview. As an example, in her first extended narrative of the interview in which she describes her idyllic, traditional childhood, /on/ is used in four of the seven tokens; this is evident, for instance, in the pronunciation of *não* ('no') as /non/ towards the end of Extract 1. In contrast, in her discussion of trips and travel and general ways of living, she uses /on/ in only four of the 14 tokens. Similarly, all five tokens of /p/ (instead of /b/) occur in contexts of highly emotional discourse, such as her narrative about the confiscation of her family's German book collection and all household items with German writing on them.[7]

An additional tool in the creation of a positive German *colono* identity are the contrasts Alice draws between her local group members and more recent arrivals to the area (Extract 4):

Extract 4

I: Certo. E [aqui]- pois aqui [tem]- tem muito brasileiro agora por causa das indústrias, né?
A: Sim, veio muita gente de fora, né? muito, muito, muito.
I: E se nota alguma diferença dos hábitos da cidade com essas pessoas que vieram?
A: <S-> sim, <u-> umas coisas pro pior.
I: Por exemplo?
A: A honestidade e os roubo, que nós non era acostumado, aí nós deixava tudo aí

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

fora, na porta, sapa:to (inint.) e: NEM recolhia de noite, a roupa ficava no varal: agora terminô tudo isso. (lines 211–223)

I: Right. And [here] so here there are many Brazilians now due to the industries, right?
A: Yes, I see many people from the outside, you know? Many, many, many.
I: And do you notice any differences in the habits of the city with the arrival of these people?
A: Yes, some things are worse.
I: For instance?
A: The honesty and the robberies because we were not accustomed to that. We used to leave everything outside, shoes (unintell.); and we would not collect them in the evening, clothing could be left hanging to dry. Now all of this is over.

Alice stresses that Panambi has changed for the worse due to the recent arrival of industrial workers, or *Brasileiros*. These new residents are blamed for the perceived increase in theft and related changes in the community. In making this point, she negatively comments on the values of these outsiders, namely lack of honesty, *vis-à-vis* her own values. Alice presents herself as German here, differentiating herself from the newcomers. She simultaneously indexes her German-ness though the pronunciation of *não* ('no') as /non/ (in keeping with the pattern described above) and through use of a (non-standard) initial weak /r/ (tap) instead of a strong /r/ (where a velar fricative or an alveolar trill is most expected) in words such as *roubo* ('robbery'), *recolhia* ('to pick up'), and *roupa* ('clothing').

Alice's metalinguistic discourse corresponds with other aspects of her identity. She names German as her primary language, and Portuguese the language acquired out of necessity: in her words, 'because we were in Brazil, right?' German is presented as the natural or obvious language for her and her family, while the need to learn Portuguese is justified and explained. In doing so, she notes that Portuguese was important because they were living in Brazil, *not*, as she might have said, because they were Brazilians. As Alice studied in a school taught by a German teacher (who was also a minister) and family life included German literacy, it is likely that she knows both Standard German and the local German dialect, although she modestly assesses her own German competence as 'medium' and her Portuguese as 'bad'. For her, the most salient aspects of language use concern code-switching and code-mixing, a topic she initiates and introduces into the interview, stressing how unfortunate it is that this practice is wide-spread. In her opinion, code-switching is not an act of identity, but a result of her restricted access to Portuguese.

If Alice's presentation of self is characterized by romantic idealization of German-Brazilian *colono* life, Lina's can be described as practical and matter-of-fact. In sharp contrast to Alice's gentle descriptions of a tender home life, Lina paints a simple if not austere picture of a family engaged in subsistence

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

farming with little disposable income. She describes, for instance, how she only had one manufactured doll in her whole life, in contrast with more recent generations that tend to purchase – as opposed to make – toys. Further, while for Alice rural tasks were a form of sporadic punishment, for Lina, such work was a routine part of life.

Lina also reveals her social position through her use of certain phonological and lexical features. A clear example is Lina's pattern of thematic vowel alternation in first person plural verb forms (specifically, /a/ realized as /e/). For instance, in discussing local churches, she states, *Mas uma vez nós contemo que tem acho que treze, catorze igrejas diferentes aqui* ('But once we counted as many as thirteen, fourteen different churches here', lines 800–802). Interestingly, Lina tends to engage in this pattern when discussing her family and home life or local community topics such as church or choir; in contrast, the two opportunities in which she does *not* use /e/ occur in the midst of discussions of outside visitors or general problems or needs within the city. Lina's use of the thematic vowel /e/ (as well as her deletion of the final *-s*) in *contemo* ('counted'), rather than the standard /a/ in *contamos* is highly stigmatized and suggestive of her lower social class origins. Non-standard thematic vowel alternation (coinciding with final *-s* deletion) tends to occur only in the speech of people with little formal education (Silva and Zilles 2000). Overall, Lina uses this thematic vowel seven out of nine times, a sharp contrast with Alice, who only does so two out of 12 times. Alice shows the same proportion of thematic vowel /e/ as assessed in the VARSUL data from both Porto Alegre and Panambi together (Silva, Maya and Zilles 1999). Thus, Lina's usage pattern of these forms sharply diverges from that of the more educated members of her speech community, a fact which is further indicative of her lower social class origins.

Although it is clear that Lina began her life at a relatively low socio-economic level, throughout the interview she also clearly signals that she has successfully moved upwards. Lina reportedly moved from the rural *interior* to the city of Panambi at 19 years old when she married someone who, although also from the *interior*, had come to the city earlier on and had achieved a higher level of education. Together they now own a small store and ice-cream parlor. Her work has shifted from rural farm tasks to local commerce, including regional travel for store purchases. Lina's family members also reflect these social advances: her brother had been able to live away from home to attend a public university to study veterinary science, and at the time of the interview, her daughter was studying medicine at the same university. In keeping with her integration with urban Brazil, Lina's speech seems to accommodate more to her interviewer and is characterized by fewer local, *colono*, or 'German' traits, as is evident in our quantitative analysis above.

Not surprisingly given her relatively low status within the German-Portuguese community initially and her recent rise in social class, Lina does not present herself as one with strong emotional connections to Germany or intense allegiance to her home area. For instance, although she knows that

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

her family is originally from Germany, she cannot recall from which area of Germany. Further, Rio Grande do Sul is not described in glorious terms as the best place in Brazil (in contrast to Alice's presentation), but more realistically as a region which also has shortcomings: she laments, for instance, that 'Panambi lacks many things. Panambi lacks doctors; Panambi lacks a good hospital'.

Rather than part of an idealized past, German cultural practices are taken for granted as an aspect of everyday life. For instance, Lina discusses many details concerning choral groups (e.g. performance schedules, traveling, song types) as blended with modern life (and not as a component of German heritage). Similarly, in responding to questions concerning the types of foods and activities that were common in the parties of her youth, although she provides descriptions of some typically German foods and recipes (e.g. *cuca*, from German *kuchen*, a type of sweet bread or cake), she also mentions items that are not typically German, but more closely associated with *gaúchos* in general (e.g. *churrasco* 'barbeque') or with Italian immigrant communities (e.g. *galeto* seasoned baby chicken cooked on a spit). Yet while Lina does not romanticize her German past, she does showcase her German identity at points throughout the interview, for instance, by opting for German pronunciation of many items (including food such as '*Streuselkuchen*', and proper names and industries). Indeed, her German pronunciation of some words is so marked that her interviewer must ask for repetition or explanation. Furthermore, although Lina only rarely replaces the standard nasal diphthong /ãw/ with/on/ (as noted in Table 1, at a rate of 5%), she tends to do so when discussing items related to her German, rural or *colono* background such as food (e.g. *pão* 'bread' with reference to German cake, or a *fogão à lenha* 'wood stove' when discussing cheese-making) or in reference to local sites (e.g. *Rincão*) or family activities (*chimarrão* 'mate').

Concomitantly, in keeping with Lina's presentation of herself as a modern, practical business woman, she also makes a point of the fact that she has traveled extensively within Brazil. She discusses a trip to Rio de Janeiro (won in a competition) she took when she was 15 and her regular trips to São Paulo to make purchases for her store, as well as giving opinions on issues related to commerce and politics. For instance, she explains that she stays away from risky Paraguay 'contraband' goods and argues for the unfairness of the competition from the *cooperativa*, which can extend credit, buy in bulk, and undercut small stores like hers. This positioning corresponds with Lina's use of forms such as *a gente* instead of *nós*, which indicates her participation in the wide-spread process of grammaticalization in which the word *gente* is losing features of an independent lexical item to become a personal pronoun (Castilho 1992; Menon 1996; Omena 1996; Omena and Braga 1996; Zilles 2002). While Alice uses *a gente* only 30 percent of the time, Lina exhibits a much higher replacement rate of 74 percent, a figure slightly above that found in the state capital, which sets the regional norm and where the process seems

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

to be most advanced. (Their age difference is perhaps particularly important in relation to *a gente* given that this ongoing change greatly accelerated in the 1960s and 1970s, when Lina was an adolescent and young adult and thus more likely to be exposed to, and to participate in, this change.)

Lina's metalinguistic discourse likewise conforms to this modern and businesslike approach. German is Lina's first language, and she learned Portuguese at school. Lina reports that Portuguese was easy to master. However, she uses multiple syntactic and lexical features that suggest less than full mastery of Brazilian Portuguese and the influence of her German L1, in Extract 5:

Extract 5

L: '[G]ente vinha a cavalo pra cidade, eu vinha a cavalo pra cidade, amarava o cavalo [nos]- nas árvores e í a comprá as coisa que *era necessário*, daí voltava. (lines 452–455)

'We would come by horse to the city, I would come by horse to the city, I would tie up the horse [to the + masc.]- to the [feminine] trees and would go to buy the things that were *necessary*, then return.'

In Extract 5, *necessário* ('necessary') refers to the feminine, *as coisa* ('the things'), and thus should be *necessárias* (feminine).[8] Lina self-initiates repair for gender before the word *árvores*, which is feminine. This type of self-repair happens several times over the interview, suggesting not only her difficulty in manipulating grammatical gender, but also her effort to accommodate to the interviewer. Furthermore, Lina uses *era* (third person singular) instead of the standard *eram* (third person plural). In this passage we also see the weak /r/ (tap) instead of the strong one in *amarrava* ('tie up') (a German trait that has proven resistant to change).

Another sign of Lina's lack of full mastery of Portuguese is her use of *ser* ('to be' for permanent states), instead of the standard *estar* ('to be' for temporary states). For instance, in discussing how one makes the German sweet bread called *cuca*, Lina explains you combine the ingredients, and then,... *quando ela é crescida, tu bota o açúcar*... ('... when it *is* risen, you put the sugar...') (lines 53–54). German does not recognize the distinction between temporary and permanent states in its copula, and this non-grammatical construction could be related to this fact. Despite these signs that Portuguese has not been fully acquired, Lina presents Portuguese as easy to master, while German, in contrast, is depicted as difficult. This is evident in Extract 6 as Lina discusses the different languages used in choir songs and spontaneously relates this to the fact that her children do not master German:

Extract 6

I: Qual é a língua mais difícil? Dessas que a senhora canta, que vocês cantam?
L: Ah! isso tu ensaiando, todos a gente consegue cantá. Hum! A italiana a gente sofre um pouco pra (inint.), pra conseguí, de pronunciá as palavras que é

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

diferente, mas isso é a mesma coisa com os outros, alemão. Que pra nós não é difícil falá alemão, mas quem não sabe, é difícil. Diz que alemão é bem mais difícil ainda. Como os meus filhos já não falam mais o alemão.

I: E a senhora fala em casa alemão?

L: Eu e meu marido falemo bastante. A mais velha fala um pouco, o segundo já fala menos e a menor não fala nada. Ela não gosta, ela não-

I: Entende?

L: Hum! E agora eles já 'tão se arrependendo que eles não (hes) falam alemão.

I: Mas entendem?

L: Entendem. Eles entendem tudo, só não falam. (lines 104–124)

I: Which is the most difficult language? Of those that you sing, that you (all) sing?

L: Well, this, by rehearsing all of them, we manage to sing. Yea! In Italian, we suffer a little in (unintell.), in order to manage, in pronouncing the words' cause it is different, but this is the same with the others, (about) German (songs). For us it is not difficult to speak German, but for those that don't know, it is difficult. They say that German is much more difficult. Like my children, they don't speak German anymore.

I: And do you speak German at home?

L: My husband and I speak a good amount. My first child speaks a little, the second speaks a little less, and the youngest doesn't speak anything. She doesn't like it, she doesn't-

I: Do they understand?

L: Hum! And now they are sorry that they don't speak German.

I: But they understand it?

L: Yes. They understand everything; but they don't speak.

As is common in contexts of language shift, the 'losing' language (in this case, German) is constructed as 'hard' and, in particular, difficult for children to learn (King 2000). It also bears noting that Lina does not seem to regret this situation: she states that her children – not her – are sorry to have not learned German. For Lina, language shift seems a natural, logical outcome given the (perceived) difficulty of the language and the changing nature of Rio Grande do Sul.

To summarize, Alice presents herself as one who is closely connected to her native region of Rio Grande do Sul, who proudly identifies as German or of German origin, and who has occupied a relatively privileged social and economic position within that social group. Lina, in contrast, presents herself as a person who – although also of German origin – is oriented toward modern, mainstream life in Brazil. She positions herself as someone who has been upwardly mobile, travels extensively, and is engaged with the social and political issues of the region. Given Lina's position, it is not surprising that she does not focus on her past, her German origins, or the positive attributes of the region as she controls greater social capital within the national (rather than the local) system. Alice and Lina's identities are also no doubt shaped by the fact that they came of age in different historical periods during which German (as well as Brazilian Portuguese) played distinct roles in signaling an individual's cultural, social, and economic status.

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

DISCUSSION

We now return to the three forms associated with German identity discussed at the outset, and in particular, to how the detailed examination of participants' discourse and identity helps us to better understand the divergent trends we saw across the three forms. Recall that in examining the replacement of stressed, word-final /ãw/ with /on/, we found variation both between and within participants' discourse as Alice was much more likely to use this markedly German feature than was Lina. Alice's greater use of /on/ seems to correspond to her stronger affiliation with her immediate German community and greater investment in her German identity. This point is further supported not only by Alice's greater use of /on/ in parts of the interview which concern her German upbringing and community life (e.g. Extracts 1 and 4), but also by Lina's tendency to do so when discussing German-linked cultural activities or customs such as food (e.g. *pão* 'bread' or *fogão à lenha* 'wood stove').

In our analysis of the retention of alveolar /l/ in word-final position, we found that both women were equally likely to make extensive use of this form. One possible explanation for this is that this feature is *not* particularly stigmatizing. This variant is perceived as belonging to dialects of Italian ancestry as well as being stereotypically *gaúcho*, and widely employed in songs, poetry, and jokes depicting traditional *gaúcho* culture and identity. The near categorical use of this feature suggests that identity issues are less salient with this rule; usage here may be constrained as an aspect of regional dialect rather than a feature creatively (and variably) employed for identity expression.

Lastly, our review of devoicing of consonants (perhaps the most widely stereotyped German speech form) suggested that, for both Lina and Alice, devoicing was rare. This might be explained by the highly stigmatized and stigmatizing nature of this variable (which is much more widely perceived than the other two). With this variable, we also saw variation within each speaker, as, for instance, Alice was more likely to use this in emotional discussions of her German origins (e.g. at the end of Extract 1, *e quanto penso hoje eu fui muito lindo isso* 'and when I think about it today, it was very lovely all of this').

The two women's use of language can be understood, at least in part, as an attempt to balance the tension between *Alemão, colono, gaúcho,* and *Brasileiro* identities. This tension is apparent in Alice's discourse about the changes in her much beloved community as a result of the arrival of the *Brasileiros* as well as her discussion of how she learned German first and Portuguese second, noting that Portuguese was needed because they were in Brazil, *not* because they were Brazilians. She positions herself then as a German *gaúcha*, not as a *Brasileira*. Lina, in turn, stresses how easily and naturally Portuguese was acquired as a second language, despite her rural and German-dominant childhood environment. She does not lament the loss of the German language in her family as Alice does. Lina's self-presentation thus stresses her identity as a *Brasileira* (concerned with social mobility and urban and commercial matters)

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

who is also fond of the *interior* and aspects of rural life and local values, which happen to be of German origin. These differences no doubt reflect the fact that the two women grew up in very different social and cultural periods with respect to the position of German language and culture (with Alice born and raised before the *Estado Novo* and Lina after it).

Our analysis of the interview transcripts also underlines the fact that for both women, identity is multilayered and at points apparently contradictory. For instance, despite a largely consistent presentation of herself as an unromantic and outward (and forward) looking person, Lina also shows a sentimental connection to her home territory. As an example, after discussing the difficulty of rural agricultural work compared to housework in the city, Lina adds 'and if I had to return, I would return to the *interior* again. I like it'. At other points, she clearly marks boundaries between insiders, such as herself, and outsiders from other areas such as Porto Alegre who come to Panambi for work (lines 1104–1112). Despite Lina's emphasis on her integration with wider Brazilian society, at points she opts to stress her identification with her local community. Alice, in turn, despite her primary allegiance to a German identity, also expresses at multiple points during the interview her strong connection to the state, the land, and to some aspects of traditional *gaúcho* life (as opposed to Brazil more generally).

CONCLUSION

Interview participants, like all of us in conversation, are continually locating and relocating themselves, while at the same time, defining who they are in relation to the world. As Schiffrin rightly observes, 'the identities that we display and that others act upon during sociolinguistic interviews, and during the narratives told during such interviews are no less situated than those whose relevance emerges during other activities' (1996: 200). Speech which occurs during sociolinguistic interviews is after all natural speech (Wolfson 1976). By approaching our participants' interviews as events which showcase identity, we have gained insights not only into the varied ways in which these women negotiate their identities as *Alemão, colono, gaúcho,* and *Brasileiro,* but into how these identities intersect in this unique context.

More specifically, we have shown how Alice and Lina situate themselves in multiple ways during the course of their interviews through the use of particular linguistic variables as well as through the content of their discourse. Our analysis of the intersection of interview discourse content and usage of variables rules within that discourse highlights how these individuals construct and present their multilayered identities. Lina's rate of non-standard thematic vowel alternation, for instance, indexes her previously lower social status and limited level of formal education; concomitantly, her high rate of *a gente* usage (instead of *nós*) places her on a par with people of her age

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

who have post-secondary education in Porto Alegre. These two opposing usage tendencies are better understood when we analyze the content of her interview in which she freely discusses her poor rural origins, her social mobility and her urban, national orientation. For Alice, in turn, we found a strikingly different pattern: a low rate of thematic vowel alternation in accordance with her higher level of formal education (a level of education which was particularly unusual for women of her generation) and elevated social status; but at the same time, a lower *a gente* usage rate, which indexes her more local orientation and corresponds to the many proud references to her German heritage in her interview. This intersection of quantitative analysis of variable rules and qualitative analysis of discourse content also points to differences *within* the interviews. For both women, we saw variation over the course of the interview with, for instance, Lina tending to engage in thematic vowel alternation in first person plural verb forms, employing /e/ instead of /a/, and Alice favoring /on/ instead of /ãw/ in stressed, word-final positions, during their discussions of local, community, and in many instances, ethnically German practices.

Our analysis of the life stories of these two women and the language they use to relate them also reminds us of the limitations of basing our understanding of the relationship between identity and language use on the analysis of usage of only one variable rule. Our study highlights the varied social significance of different variables even when these variables are directly related to the speakers' first language (in this case, German) and constitute what is generally treated as interference or transfer from the first language. For instance, while alveolar /l/ has been maintained and is almost categorical for both speakers, devoicing is highly avoided by both of them. In contrast, use of /on/ instead of /ãw/ characterizes the speech of Alice but not Lina. Thus, interference is a less powerful explanatory factor (as both have German as their first language) than the ecology of variants within the local community and the orientation of the individual speakers within this ecology (Haugen 1972).

Lastly, we hope that our discussion has illustrated the potential value of including analysis of the content of interview discourse, and, in particular, analysis of how participants position themselves and their identities within this content, as a component of more standard quantitative analysis in cases where ethnographic data is inaccessible. Our close analysis of interview discourse here has allowed us to better understand and explain speakers' divergent and fluctuating use of multiple linguistic variables, moving beyond labels such as 'young' or 'old' and 'high' or 'low' levels of formal education. More generally, such qualitative discourse analysis has the potential to shed light on how language is used to perform different aspects of identity, a point of particular importance given the growing awareness of the blurry lines between 'social' and 'stylistic' variation (Johnstone 2000). Conversely, for those interested in identity, databases such as VARSUL can provide not only speech samples for variationist analysis, but important insights into identity construction more generally. Such databases can help infer the linguistic and cultural attitudes

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

prevailing in different communities, leading to a better understanding of the ecology of variants at hand.

NOTES

1. For contingency tables of two-by-two, the Yates's correction was included. A $p \leq .05$ was required to claim that differences between the speakers were significant.
2. Only devoicing is exclusively associated with German-ness; the other two variables are also associated with Italian ancestry or with *colono* or 'from the *interior*' identity.
3. This realization is interpreted as interference because there are no nasal vowels in the phonological inventory of German.
4. According to Ponso (2003) this feature is also found in Italian communities.
5. For native speakers of Portuguese the unstressed word-final nasal diphthong variably tends to be reduced: homem ['omy] > ['omi]; levaram [le'varãw] > [le'varu] (Vandresen 1999: 69). This process is sometimes called denasalization, as in Guy (1981). Although we have not computed them systematically, both Alice and Lina show this kind of reduction.
6. Transcript excerpts are intended to represent Alice and Lina's grammatical and pronounciation patterns, which at points diverge from Standard Brazilian Portuguese. Bolded items refer to features which are discussed in the text of the paper.
7. It should be added that at least in some cases there are other strong reasons leading to devoicing: for instance, the word *biblioteca* ('library') is said harmoniously as [piplio'tɛka], with only voiceless consonants; the same applies to the word *babaçu* ('a specific type of fruit'), which is said as [papa'su].
8. We have not included lack of numerical agreement because this feature is widespread in Brazilian Portuguese (see, for instance, Guy 1981; Scherre 1996a, 1996b).

REFERENCES

Auer, Peter, Jacinta Arnhold and Cintia Bueno-Aniola. In press. Being a 'colono' and being 'daitsch' in Rio Grande do Sul: Linguistic heterogeneity as a resource for social categorization. Freiburg Colloquium on 'Acts of Identity'. To appear in Peter Auer and Werner Kallmeyer (eds.) *Social Identity and Communicative Styles – An Alternative Approach to Linguistic Variability*. Berlin, Germany: Walter de Gruyter.

Baernert-Fuerst, Ute. 1989. Flashes metodológicos: A sociolingüística qualitiva/quantitiva. In Fernando Tarallo (ed.) *Fotografias Sociolingüísticas*. Campinas, Brazil: Pontes: Editora da Universidade Estadual de Campinas. 219–237.

Bell, Allan. 1999. Styling the other to define the self: A study in New Zealand identity making. *Journal of Sociolinguistics* 3: 523–541.

Bucholtz, Mary. 1999. You da man: Narrating the racial other in the production of white masculinity. *Journal of Sociolinguistics* 3: 443–460.

Cameron, Deborah. 2001. *Working with Spoken Discourse*. London: Sage Publications.

Castilho, Ataliba T. de. 1992. O Português do Brasil. In Rodolfo Ilari (ed.) *Lingüística Românica*. São Paulo, Brazil: Ática. 237–269.

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

Coupland, Nikolas. 2001. Dialect stylization in radio talk. *Language in Society* 30: 345–375.

Cunha, Jorge Luiz da. 1996. A História Social da Alemanha e o estudo dos dialetos das populações imigrantes no Rio Grande do Sul. Paper presented at I Encontro de Variação Lingüística do Cone Sul, Universidade Federal do Rio Grande do Sul, Porto Alegre, Brazil.

Eckert, Penelope. 2000. *Linguistic Variation as Social Practice*. Oxford, U.K.: Blackwell.

Guy, Gregory R. 1981. Linguistic variation in Brazilian Portuguese: Aspects of the phonology, syntax, and language history. Unpublished PhD dissertation. Philadelphia, Pennsylvania: University of Pennsylvania.

Haugen, Einar. 1972. The ecology of language. In Anuar Dil (ed.) *The Ecology of Language: Essays by Einar Haugen*. Stanford, California: Stanford University Press. 324–339.

Johnstone, Barbara. 1996. *The Linguistic Individual: Self-expression in Language and Linguistics*. New York: Oxford University Press.

Johnstone, Barbara. 1999. Uses of Southern-sounding speech by contemporary Texas women. *Journal of Sociolinguistics* 3: 505–522.

Johnstone, Barbara. 2000. The individual voice in language. *Annual Review of Anthropology* 29: 405–424.

King, Kendall A. 2000. Language ideologies and heritage language education. *International Journal of Bilingual Education and Bilingualism* 3: 167–184.

Knies, Clarice B. and Iara B. Costa. 1996. Manual do Usuário – Banco de Dados Lingüísticos VARSUL. Unpublished document. UFRGS/Porto Alegre and UFPR/Curitiba.

Menon, Odete P. da S. 1996. *A gente*: Um processo de gramaticalização. *Estudos Lingüísticos* 25: 622–628.

Omena, Nelize P. de. 1996. A referência à primeira pessoa do plural. In Giselle Machline de Oliveira e Silva and Maria Marta P. Scherre (eds.) *Padrões Sociolingüísticos: Análise de Fenômenos Variáveis do Português Falado na Cidade do Rio de Janeiro*. Rio de Janeiro, Brazil: Tempo Brasileiro, Depto. de Lingüística e Filologia, UFRJ. 183–216.

Omena, Nelize P. de and Maria Luiza Braga. 1996. *A gente* está se gramaticalizando? In Alzira. T. de Macedo, Cláudia Roncarati and Maria Cecília Mollica (eds.) *Variação e Discurso*. Rio de Janeiro, Brazil: Tempo Brasileiro. 75–83.

Ponso, Letícia C. 2003. A Variação no Português em Contato com o Italiano na Comunidade Bilíngüe de São Marcos, RS. Unpublished Masters thesis. Porto Alegre, Brazil: Universidade Federal do Rio Grande do Sul.

Prade, Helga G. 1996. Interferências lingüísticas no português falado no Rio Grande do Sul, em regiões de colonização alemã. Paper presented at I Encontro de Variação Lingüística do Cone Sul. Universidade Federal do Rio Grande do Sul, Porto Alegre, Brazil.

Rampton, Ben. 1995. *Crossing: Language and Ethnicity Among Adolescents*. London: Longman.

Rampton, Ben (ed.). 1999. Styling the 'Other': Introduction. *Journal of Sociolinguistics* 3: 421–427.

Scherre, Maria Marta P. 1996a. Sobre a influência de variáveis sociais na concordância nominal em português. In Giselle Machline de Oliveira e Silva and Maria Marta P. Scherre (eds.) *Padrões Sociolingüísticos: Análise de Fenômenos Variáveis do Português Falado na Cidade do Rio de Janeiro*. Rio de Janeiro, Brazil. Tempo Brasileiro: Depto. de Lingüística e Filologia, UFRJ. 239–264.

Scherre, Maria Marta P. 1996b. Sobre a influência de três variáveis relacionadas na concordância nominal em português. In Giselle Machline de

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005

Oliveira e Silva and Maria Marta P. Scherre (eds.) *Padrões Sociolingüísticos: Análise de Fenômenos Variáveis do Português Falado na Cidade do Rio de Janeiro.* Rio de Janeiro, Brazil: Tempo Brasileiro: Depto. de Lingüística e Filologia, UFRJ. 85–117.

Schiffrin, Deborah. 1996. Narrative as self-portrait: Sociolinguistic constructions of identity. *Language in Society* 25: 167–203.

Schilling-Estes, Natalie. 2004. Constructing ethnicity in interaction. *Journal of Sociolinguistics* 8: 163–195.

Seyferth, Gyralda. n.d. Etnicidade e cultura: a constituição da identidade Teuto-Brasileira. In George C. L. Zarur (ed.) *Etnia e Nação na América* II. Washington, D. C.: Centro Editorial La Educación, OEA. 17–36.

Seyferth, Gyralda. 1991. Observações sobre o tema imigração e raça no Brasil. *Estudos Afro-Asiáticos* 20: 165–185.

Silva, Karine Q., Leonardo Z. Maya and Ana M. S. Zilles. 1999. A Concordância Verbal com a Primeira Pessoa do Plural na Fala de Panambi e Porto Alegre. Paper presented at XI Salão de Iniciação Científica da Universidade Federal do Rio Grande do Sul. Porto Alegre, Brazil.

Silva, Karine Q. and Ana M. S. Zilles. 2000. A variação na concordância verbal com a primeira pessoa do plural na fala de Porto Alegre, RS. Paper presented at IV Encontro do Círculo de Estudos Linqüísticos do Sul – CELSUL. Universidade Federal do Paraná, Curitiba, Brazil.

Tasca, Maria. 2000. A Lateral Pós-Vocálica em Coda Silábica no Sul do Brasil. Unpublished PhD dissertation. Porto Alegre, Brazil: Pontifícia Universidade Católica do Rio Grande do Sul.

Trevisan, Janine Bendorovicz and Ana M. S. Zilles. 2001. Alternância de códigos, mistura de línguas, língua e dialeto na visão dos informantes de Panambi/Varsul, de. Paper presented at XII Encontro Regional do Projeto Varsul, UFRGS, Porto Alegre, Brazil.

Vandresen, Paulino. 1999. Visão panorâmica da variação no português falado na região sul. In Dermeval da Hora and Elizabeth Christiano (eds.) *Estudos Lingüísticos: Realidade Brasileira.* João Pessoa, Brazil: Idéia. 63–82.

Wolfson, Nessa. 1976. Speech events and natural speech: Some implications for sociolinguistic methodology. *Language in Society* 5: 189–209.

Zilles, Ana M. S. 1994. Projeto VARSUL: banco de dados e projetos de análise. *Cadernos do Instituto de Letras* (Universidade Federal do Rio Grande do Sul, Porto Alegre, Brazil) 12: 29–31.

Zilles, Ana M. S. 2002. Grammaticalization of *a gente* in Brazilian Portuguese. In Daniel Ezra Johnson and Tara Sanchez (eds.) *University of Pennsylvania Working Papers in Linguistics* 8: 297–310.

Address correspondence to:

Kendall King
Department of Linguistics
Georgetown University
Intercultural Centre 458
Washington, D.C. 20057
U.S.A.

akk25@georgetown.edu

© Blackwell Publishing Ltd. 2005